



AFTER

The surrender at Appomattox removed the last Confederate hopes of a negotiated peace, but it did not in fact end the war.

THE SOUTH BEHEADED

General Lee's surrender **did not apply to all Confederate forces** in the field. In theory, other troops in other theaters were free to fight on. In practice, though, none stood a realistic chance of long-term military success. April 1865 had seen the **South lose both its capital and its principal fighting force**. With Lee defeated and Confederate President Jefferson Davis in flight (see [Meeting with Davis](#)), the South had no leader. General **Joseph E. Johnston** surrendered in North Carolina on **April 26**, General **Richard Taylor** in Alabama on **May 4**, and General **Kirby Smith** in the Trans-Mississippi region on **May 26**, (see [Johnston surrenders](#)).